

Grants & Resources for Farmers & Ranchers

Farming and ranching have some of the richest federal support of any business — loans, grants, conservation payments, and beginning-farmer programs. Below are the main USDA resources. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

The USDA is your main partner here, with programs for beginning, veteran, and underserved farmers. Your local USDA Service Center staff help you apply for free — start there.

1 Start With Your Local USDA Office

One visit connects you to loans, grants, and conservation help.

☐ Find Your USDA Service Center

Local staff help beginning and existing farmers access every USDA program.

→ www.farmers.gov/working-with-us/service-center-locator

☐ Farmers.gov — Get Started

USDA's plain-language hub for new and existing farmers.

→ www.farmers.gov/your-business/beginning-farmers

2 Farm Loans

USDA loans for land, equipment, livestock, and operating costs.

☐ FSA Farm Loans

Direct and guaranteed loans, including special funds for beginning and underserved farmers.

→ www.fsa.usda.gov/resources/programs/farm-loan-programs

☐ Microloans for Farmers

Smaller, simpler loans up to \$50,000 for new and small operations.

→ www.fsa.usda.gov/resources/programs/farm-loan-programs/microloans

3 Grants & Value-Added Funding

Grants to grow, add products, and reach new markets.

☐ Value-Added Producer Grants

Funding to turn raw products into higher-value goods.

→ www.rd.usda.gov/programs-services/business-programs/value-added-producer-grants

☐ SARE — Sustainable Ag Grants

Grants for sustainable farming projects and research.

→ www.sare.org/grants

☐ Rural Business Development Grants

USDA grants supporting small rural businesses, including farm enterprises.

→ www.rd.usda.gov/programs-services/business-programs/rural-business-development-grants

4 Conservation Payments

Get paid to improve and protect your land.

☐ NRCS Conservation Programs (EQIP, CSP)

Financial help for conservation practices that also cut your costs.

→ www.nrcs.usda.gov/programs-initiatives

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Beware of private “farm grant” services charging fees — USDA help is free through your local Service Center. Watch deadlines too; many farm programs have specific sign-up periods.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Ask specifically about “beginning farmer” and “socially disadvantaged farmer” set-asides — USDA reserves funds for these groups, and your local office can tell you if you qualify.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national USDA programs. For your local Service Center, state ag programs, and regional grants, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
